

UI/UX Design Brief

App: CareerGuid AI / SkillSight

Role: Senior UI/UX Designer

Purpose

This brief is written so an AI app builder can create the UI without guessing.

1. Design Vision

CareerGuid AI should feel like a modern AI career assistant: clean, trustworthy, focused, and motivating.

The user should never feel confused about what to do next. The app should guide them step by step:

Upload resume

- > AI auto-fills profile
- > User edits missing details
- > Skill gap analysis
- > Personalized roadmap
- > Weekly progress tracking
- > ATS resume builder
- > Job-ready profile

The design should combine:

- Clean SaaS dashboard style
- Friendly AI assistant feeling
- Career/professional trust
- Learning progress motivation
- Simple onboarding flow

Use Material Design-style color roles, component consistency, and hierarchy as inspiration because Material Design provides structured color and typography systems for accessible UI design.

Also follow platform-level usability principles from Apple Human Interface Guidelines for layout clarity, readable typography, and user-friendly interaction patterns.

2. Design Style

2.1 Overall Style Direction

Style name: Modern AI SaaS + Career Dashboard

Visual feeling:

Clean
Trustworthy
Professional
AI-powered
Soft
Motivating
Minimal
Premium

Avoid:

Too many gradients
Too much dark UI
Too many icons
Overloaded dashboard
Complex navigation
Aggressive colors
Unclear AI outputs

The app should feel similar to:

Reference	What to take
Notion	Clean layout, readable spacing, calm interface
Linear	Sharp SaaS dashboard, clean cards, premium feel
Duolingo	Progress motivation, streak/reminder psychology
Coursera	Learning roadmap and course-like task structure
Grammarly	AI suggestions and correction flow
Supabase	Developer-friendly clean green-accent UI

3. Color Palette

3.1 Primary Brand Colors

Use a professional green-blue AI theme because the project uses Supabase and career growth concepts.

Token	Color	Hex	Usage
Primary	Emerald Green	#10B981	Main CTA, active states, success, progress
Primary Dark	Deep Emerald	#047857	Hover state, strong emphasis
Primary Light	Soft Mint	#D1FAE5	Background highlights
Secondary	Indigo	#4F46E5	AI features, roadmap, premium actions
Accent	Sky Blue	#0EA5E9	Links, info states, charts

3.2 Neutral Colors

Token	Color	Hex	Usage
Background	Off White	#F8FAFC	Main page background
Surface	White	FFFFFF	Cards, forms, modals
Surface Soft	Light Gray	#F1F5F9	Secondary sections
Border	Gray 200	#E2E8F0	Card borders, input borders
Text Primary	Slate 900	#0F172A	Headings
Text Secondary	Slate 600	#475569	Paragraphs
Text Muted	Slate 400	#94A3B8	Labels, hints
Disabled	Gray 300	#CBD5E1	Disabled buttons

3.3 Semantic Colors

State	Color	Hex	Usage
Success	Green	#22C55E	Completed tasks, success toast
Warning	Amber	#F59E0B	Pending tasks, reminders
Error	Red	#EF4444	Errors, validation
Info	Blue	#3B82F6	Informational banners
Premium	Purple	#8B5CF6	Upgrade plan, premium features

3.4 Gradient Usage

Use gradients only in hero, AI cards, and premium upgrade banners.

Primary gradient:

```
background: linear-gradient(135deg, #10B981 0%, #0EA5E9 100%);
```

AI gradient:

```
background: linear-gradient(135deg, #4F46E5 0%, #8B5CF6 100%);
```

Premium gradient:

```
background: linear-gradient(135deg, #7C3AED 0%, #EC4899 100%);
```

Do not use gradients on every card. Most UI should stay clean and white.

4. Accessibility Rules

The app should follow WCAG 2.2 accessibility standards. Normal text should target at least 4.5:1 contrast, and large text at least 3:1.

Rules:

- All text must be readable on background.
- Do not use color alone to show status.
- Every icon-only button must have aria-label.
- Inputs must have labels.
- Focus states must be visible.
- Buttons must be keyboard accessible.
- Error messages must appear near the field.

Focus ring:

```
outline: 2px solid #10B981;  
outline-offset: 2px;
```

5. Typography

5.1 Font Family

Use:

```
font-family: "Inter", "Segoe UI", Roboto, Arial, sans-serif;
```

Reason: Inter is modern, clean, readable, and common in SaaS dashboards.

5.2 Type Scale

Style	Size	Weight	Line Height	Usage
Display	48px	700	56px	Landing hero title
H1	36px	700	44px	Page title
H2	28px	700	36px	Section title

Style	Size	Weight	Line Height	Usage
H3	22px	600	30px	Card title
H4	18px	600	26px	Subsection title
Body Large	16px	400	26px	Main content
Body	14px	400	22px	Dashboard text
Caption	12px	500	18px	Labels, badges
Button	14px	600	20px	Buttons

5.3 Typography Rules

Use H1 only once per page.

Use body text in 14px or 16px.

Do not use very thin font weights.

Keep paragraph width under 720px.

Use bold only for emphasis, not entire paragraphs.

6. Layout System

6.1 Spacing Scale

Use an 8px spacing system.

4px = tiny gap

8px = small gap

12px = compact spacing

16px = default spacing

24px = card spacing

32px = section spacing

48px = major section spacing

64px = hero spacing

6.2 Border Radius

Element	Radius
Small input	8px
Button	10px
Card	16px
Modal	20px
Hero card	24px
Full dashboard panel	24px

6.3 Shadow System

Use soft shadows only.

```
--shadow-sm: 0 1px 2px rgba(15, 23, 42, 0.06);  
--shadow-md: 0 8px 24px rgba(15, 23, 42, 0.08);  
--shadow-lg: 0 16px 40px rgba(15, 23, 42, 0.12);
```

Rules:

Use border + subtle shadow for cards.

Do not use heavy black shadows.

Hover cards can increase shadow slightly.

7. Desktop Layout Rules

Desktop breakpoint:

Desktop: 1024px and above

Tablet: 768px to 1023px

Mobile: below 768px

7.1 Desktop App Layout

Authenticated layout:

Left Sidebar: 260px fixed

Top Header: 72px height

Main Content: fluid

Right Panel: optional, 320px

Structure:

```
+-----+  
| Top Header |  
+-----+  
| Sidebar | Main Content |  
| 260px | Dashboard / Pages |  
| | |  
+-----+
```

Main content width:

```
max-width: 1280px;
```

```
margin: 0 auto;
```

```
padding: 32px;
```

8. Mobile Layout Rules

Mobile behavior:

Sidebar becomes bottom navigation or hamburger drawer.

Cards become single-column.

Tables become stacked cards.

Forms use full-width inputs.

Primary CTA stays sticky at bottom on long forms.

Roadmap weeks become accordion list.

Mobile header:

Logo left

Menu icon right

Height: 64px

Mobile bottom nav items:

Dashboard

Roadmap

Resume

Profile

Do not show all sidebar items in bottom nav. Keep only top 4 actions.

9. Component Design System

9.1 Buttons

Primary Button

Usage:

Signup

Login

Upload Resume

Analyze Skill Gap

Generate Roadmap

Generate Resume

Upgrade

Style:

background: #10B981;

color: #FFFFFF;

border-radius: 10px;

height: 44px;

padding: 0 20px;

font-weight: 600;

border: none;

Hover:

background: #047857;

Disabled:

background: #CBD5E1;

color: #64748B;

cursor: not-allowed;

Loading:

Show spinner left + loading text.

Example: Generating...

Secondary Button

Usage:

Cancel

Back

View Details

Edit Profile

Style:

background: #FFFFFF;

color: #0F172A;

border: 1px solid #E2E8F0;

border-radius: 10px;

height: 44px;

padding: 0 20px;

font-weight: 600;

Hover:

background: #F8FAFC;

Danger Button

Usage:

Delete resume

Delete account

Remove document

Style:


```
background: #EF4444;  
color: #FFFFFF;  
border-radius: 10px;
```

Always show confirmation modal before destructive action.

Link Button

Usage:

```
Forgot password  
Resend OTP  
View roadmap  
Change plan
```

Style:

```
color: #0EA5E9;  
font-weight: 600;  
text-decoration: none;
```

Hover:

```
text-decoration: underline;
```

10. Card Style

10.1 Standard Card

Use for dashboard blocks, feature cards, roadmap cards.

```
background: #FFFFFF;  
border: 1px solid #E2E8F0;  
border-radius: 16px;  
box-shadow: 0 1px 2px rgba(15, 23, 42, 0.06);  
padding: 24px;
```

Hover card:

```
transform: translateY(-2px);  
box-shadow: 0 8px 24px rgba(15, 23, 42, 0.08);
```

10.2 AI Highlight Card

Use for AI insights, AI-generated roadmap, ATS suggestions.

```
background: linear-gradient(135deg, #EEF2FF 0%, #ECFDF5 100%);  
border: 1px solid #C7D2FE;
```

```
border-radius: 20px;
padding: 24px;
```

Include small badge:

AI Generated

Badge style:

```
background: #EEF2FF;
color: #4F46E5;
border-radius: 999px;
padding: 4px 10px;
font-size: 12px;
font-weight: 600;
```

10.3 Warning Card

Use when user is behind roadmap.

```
background: #FFFBEA;
border: 1px solid #FDE68A;
color: #92400E;
border-radius: 16px;
```

Message:

You have pending tasks for this week. Complete them to stay on track.

11. Form Design

11.1 Input Style

```
height: 44px;
border: 1px solid #CBD5E1;
border-radius: 10px;
padding: 0 12px;
font-size: 14px;
background: #FFFFFF;
```

Focus:

```
border-color: #10B981;
box-shadow: 0 0 0 3px rgba(16, 185, 129, 0.15);
```

Error:

```
border-color: #EF4444;
background: #FEE2F2;
```

11.2 Labels

```
font-size: 14px;  
font-weight: 600;  
color: #0F172A;  
margin-bottom: 6px;
```

Required field:

Full Name *

Error text:

```
font-size: 12px;  
color: #EF4444;  
margin-top: 4px;
```

12. Badges and Status Pills

12.1 Source Badges for Onboarding

Status	Text	Style
Auto-filled	Auto-filled	Green badge
Manual	Manual	Blue badge
Missing	Missing	Red badge
Low confidence	Review needed	Amber badge

Green badge:

```
background: #D1FAE5;  
color: #047857;
```

Blue badge:

```
background: #DBEAFE;  
color: #1D4ED8;
```

Amber badge:

```
background: #FEF3C7;  
color: #92400E;
```

Red badge:

```
background: #FEE2E2;  
color: #B91C1C;
```

13. Page-by-Page UI Design

13.1 Landing Page

Layout

Navbar
Hero Section
Problem Section
How It Works
Feature Grid
AI Preview Section
Pricing Teaser
FAQ
Footer

Hero Section

Left side:

Headline
Subtitle
CTA buttons
Trust badges

Right side:

Dashboard preview mockup
Resume upload preview
Skill gap score preview

Hero title:

Build your job-ready career path with AI

Hero subtitle:

Upload your resume, discover missing skills, generate a personalized roadmap, and create an

Buttons:

Get Started
View Features

Hero visual:

Floating dashboard card showing:

- Match Score: 58%
- Missing Skills: Node.js, Redis, System Design
- Roadmap Progress: 35%

13.2 Signup Page

Layout:

Left: Brand message / illustration

Right: Signup form card

Signup form card:

Title: Create your account

Subtitle: Start your AI career analysis today.

Fields:

- Full Name
- Email
- Password
- Confirm Password

Button: Create Account

Link: Already have an account? Login

Design:

Centered card

Max width: 420px

Card padding: 32px

13.3 Login Page

Layout same as signup.

Fields:

Email

Password

Buttons:

Login

Forgot Password

Create Account

Success redirect rules:

Email not verified -> Verify Email

Onboarding not completed -> Resume Upload

Completed -> Dashboard

13.4 Resume Upload Onboarding Screen

This is one of the most important screens.

Layout

Page Title

Short explanation

Large upload card

Supported format info

Security note

CTA

Upload card:

Icon: file upload

Text: Drag and drop your resume here

Subtext: PDF or DOCX, max 5 MB

Button: Browse File

After file selected:

Show file name

Show file size

Show remove file button

Button: Analyze Resume

Loading state:

Step 1: Uploading resume

Step 2: Extracting profile details

Step 3: Preparing editable form

Use progress indicator:

Uploading -> Analyzing -> Ready

13.5 Auto-Filled Profile Review Screen

Layout:

Left: Form sections

Right: Profile completion card

Sections:

Personal Details

Education

Skills

Projects

Links

Career Preferences

Every auto-filled field should show badge:

Auto-filled

Every missing field should show:

Missing

Right side card:

Profile Completion: 78%

Auto-filled fields: 9

Missing fields: 4

Review needed: 2

Primary CTA:

Save and Continue

Secondary CTA:

Re-upload Resume

13.6 Dashboard

Dashboard should be card-based and action-focused.

Desktop Dashboard Layout

Top Row:

- Welcome card
- Profile completion
- Target role
- Reminder status

Middle Row:

- Skill Gap Summary
- Roadmap Progress
- ATS Resume Status

Bottom Row:

- Pending Tasks
- AI Suggestions
- Recent Activity

Dashboard Header

Good morning, Nitin

Here is your career progress for Backend Developer.

Primary CTA:

Continue Roadmap

Secondary CTA:

Build ATS Resume

Dashboard Cards

Profile Completion Card

Profile Completion

78%

Progress bar

Button: Complete Profile

Skill Gap Card

Skill Match Score

58%

Current Skills: Java, SQL, HTML

Missing Skills: Node.js, Redis, System Design

Button: View Skill Gap

Roadmap Progress Card

Roadmap Progress

35%

Week 2 of 6

Pending tasks: 3

Button: Continue Roadmap

Reminder Status Card

Reminder Status

You have 3 pending tasks this week.

Last reminder sent: 27 June 2026

ATS Resume Card

ATS Resume

Not generated yet

Button: Generate Resume

13.7 Skill Gap Page

Layout:

Top: Target role selector

Middle: Match score visualization

Bottom: Missing skills and learning order

Match score visual:

Circular progress chart
Score: 58%
Label: Moderate match
Skill tags:
Current Skills: green tags
Missing Skills: red/amber tags
Recommended Skills: blue tags
CTA:
Generate Personalized Roadmap

13.8 Roadmap Page

Use a learning platform style.

Layout:

Header:

- Roadmap title
- Target role
- Progress percentage

Main:

- Week-wise roadmap accordion

Right:

- Upcoming tasks
- Reminder status

Week card:

Week 1: JavaScript Basics

Status: Completed / Pending

Tasks:

- [] Learn variables and functions
- [] Practice loops
- [] Understand ES6 features

Completed task:

Checkbox checked

Text slightly muted

Completed badge

Pending task:

Checkbox unchecked

Due date visible

Behind schedule task:

Amber warning border

Text: Pending from last week

13.9 ATS Resume Builder

Layout:

Left: Resume editor

Right: Live preview

Sections:

Summary

Skills

Education

Projects

Experience

Certifications

Links

Buttons:

Generate Resume

Improve with AI

Save Changes

Download PDF

Download DOCX

Regenerate

AI suggestion pattern:

Original:

Built a book app.

Improved:

Developed a full-stack book sharing application with user authentication, book listing, search

Use side-by-side comparison for AI improvements.

13.10 Billing Page

Layout:

Current Plan Card

Usage Limits

Pricing Cards

Billing History

Pricing cards:

Free
Pro
Premium

Highlight recommended plan:

Pro
Badge: Recommended

Upgrade button:

Upgrade to Pro

Premium card should use purple gradient header.

14. Modals

14.1 Confirmation Modal

Used for:

Delete resume
Delete account
Re-upload resume
Cancel payment

Structure:

Title
Description
Cancel button
Confirm button

Danger confirm button should be red.

14.2 Upgrade Modal

Trigger when user reaches free limit.

Title:

Upgrade to continue

Message:

You have reached your free ATS resume generation limit. Upgrade to Pro to generate more resu

Buttons:

Upgrade Now
Maybe Later

14.3 AI Processing Modal

Used for long AI tasks.

Content:

AI is working on your request

Step indicator

Progress animation

Estimated message, not exact timer

Do not show fake percentage unless backend provides real progress.

15. Empty State Design

Empty states should be helpful and action-oriented.

Style

Small illustration/icon

Clear title

Helpful explanation

Primary CTA

Example:

Title: No roadmap yet

Text: Generate a personalized roadmap based on your missing skills.

Button: Generate Roadmap

16. Error State Design

Error states should explain what happened and what user can do next.

Example:

Title: Resume parsing failed

Text: We could not extract details from your resume. You can retry or continue manually.

Buttons:

- Retry
- Fill manually

Use red only for actual errors.

17. Success State Design

Success states should be encouraging.

Example:

Title: Your roadmap is ready

Text: We created a 6-week roadmap for your Backend Developer goal.

Button: Start Roadmap

Use green accent and subtle celebration icon.

18. Loading States

Use skeleton loaders for dashboard cards.

Use step loaders for AI processes:

Uploading resume...

Extracting profile details...

Generating roadmap...

Optimizing ATS resume...

Do not show blank screens during loading.

19. Icon Style

Use simple line icons.

Recommended icon style:

Lucide Icons

Stroke width: 2px

Rounded caps

24px default size

Icon usage:

Feature	Icon
Resume Upload	UploadCloud
Skill Gap	BarChart
Roadmap	Map
ATS Resume	FileText
Reminder	Bell
Profile	User

Feature	Icon
Billing	CreditCard
Settings	Settings
AI	Sparkles

20. Data Visualization

Use simple charts only.

Charts:

Circular progress for match score
Linear progress bar for roadmap completion
Bar chart for skill category coverage
Small line chart for weekly progress

Colors:

Completed: Green
Pending: Amber
Missing: Red
Recommended: Blue
Premium: Purple

21. Responsive Behavior

Desktop

Sidebar visible
Cards in 2-3 columns
ATS builder split view
Dashboard full layout
Tables visible

Tablet

Sidebar collapses
Cards in 2 columns
ATS preview moves below editor

Mobile

Bottom nav
Cards single column
Forms full width
Roadmap accordion
ATS editor only first, preview as separate tab
Sticky bottom CTA

Mobile ATS tabs:

Edit
Preview
Download

22. Motion and Microinteractions

Use subtle motion only.

Button hover: slight darkening
Card hover: lift 2px
Modal open: fade + scale
Toast: slide from top-right
Progress update: smooth width animation
Checkbox complete: small success animation

Duration:

`transition: all 180ms ease;`

Avoid:

Bouncy animations
Slow animations
Too many moving elements

23. UX Principles

23.1 Reduce Manual Work

Resume upload should come first. AI should auto-fill as much as possible.

23.2 Always Show Next Step

Every page should have a clear primary CTA.

Examples:

Upload Resume
Review Profile
Analyze Skill Gap
Generate Roadmap
Continue Roadmap
Build Resume

23.3 Build Trust

Show:

Your data is secure
Resume is stored privately
You can edit AI-filled details
AI suggestions are editable

23.4 Make AI Explainable

Do not just show AI output. Show why.

Example:

We recommended Node.js because it is required for Backend Developer roles and missing from y

23.5 Keep Users Motivated

Use:

Progress bars
Weekly goals
Completion badges
Reminder messages
Motivational empty states

24. Design Tokens for AI App Builder

Use these exact tokens:

```
:root {  
  --color-primary: #10B981;  
  --color-primary-dark: #047857;  
  --color-primary-light: #D1FAE5;  
  
  --color-secondary: #4F46E5;  
  --color-accent: #0EA5E9;
```



```

--color-premium: #8B5CF6;

--color-bg: #F8FAFC;
--color-surface: #FFFFFF;
--color-surface-soft: #F1F5F9;
--color-border: #E2E8F0;

--color-text-primary: #0F172A;
--color-text-secondary: #475569;
--color-text-muted: #94A3B8;

--color-success: #22C55E;
--color-warning: #F59E0B;
--color-error: #EF4444;
--color-info: #3B82F6;

--radius-sm: 8px;
--radius-md: 10px;
--radius-lg: 16px;
--radius-xl: 24px;

--shadow-sm: 0 1px 2px rgba(15, 23, 42, 0.06);
--shadow-md: 0 8px 24px rgba(15, 23, 42, 0.08);
--shadow-lg: 0 16px 40px rgba(15, 23, 42, 0.12);
}

```

25. Final Design Summary

CareerGuid AI should look like a premium AI SaaS dashboard for career growth.

The app should feel:

Professional like LinkedIn
 Clean like Notion
 Smart like Grammarly
 Motivating like Duolingo
 Structured like Coursera
 Developer-modern like Supabase

The most important UI experience:

User uploads resume first
 AI auto-fills profile
 User edits missing/incorrect details
 System shows skill gap clearly

AI creates a simple roadmap
User tracks weekly progress
System reminds user if they fall behind
User creates ATS resume and downloads it

Final design principle:

Make the user feel guided, not overwhelmed. Every screen should answer: “What should I do next?”